

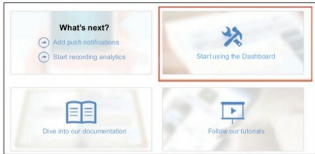
Figure 16: What happens after clicking on the *Test* button

Figure 17: After testing the next step options

Pricing

The major factors for MBaaS pricing are:

- The number of API calls
- The type and size of storage
- Active user pricing
- The number of application builds
- Premium fees for analytics
- Feature based pricing – for push mail, chat, sync, email, etc
- Support and maintenance costs

Case study: Parse.com

Parse is a start-up company that was acquired by Facebook and provides MBaaS. According to a case study by Amazon, Parse provides server management for over 180,000 Android, iOS and Windows mobile applications, which run on more than 200 million mobile devices. One can see the hundreds of Parse customers at <https://parse.com/customers>.

Sample application

Using Parse is relatively easy. Open parse.com and click on *Sign up for free*, which is shown in Figure 7. Fill in the necessary details and create an application name of your choice. This demo will show a very simple and primitive application to demonstrate how easily data can be stored on the cloud using Parse.

Fill in the necessary details and click on *Signup*. Once registered, log in to parse.com, which will show what Parse is capable of in terms of a BaaS (Figure 8).

Select the data icon so that we can store some data. Parse will ask for environments (Figure 9).

Parse supports a variety of environments for which it can provide back-end as a service. Select *Mobile* as an environment, which will display the available platforms in the mobile environment as shown in Figure 10.

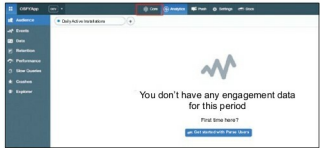


Figure 18: Dashboard view

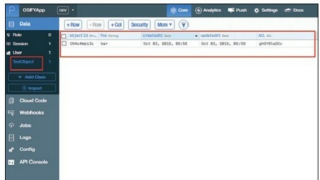


Figure 19: Data view

Select *Android* as the platform. It will display language options as shown in Figure 11.

Select *Native (Java)*, and you will be asked whether to start with a new or existing project as shown in Figure 12.

Select *New Project* which will show some options for the SDK as shown in Figure 13.

Download the blank project, and import the same in Android Studio.

At the bottom of the page, there is dummy code to store the data as shown in Figure 14.

Open Android Studio, find the *StarterApplication.java* file and paste the highlighted code of the *onCreate* method (Figure 15).

Run the application in the emulator which will store the code in the parse.com site. On the same page of parse.com there is a *Test* button and clicking on it will show the data creation (Figure 16).

To view the data later, click on the dashboard option as shown in Figure 17.

The dashboard will open in *Analytics* view. Click on *Core* as shown in Figure 18.

Click on *TestObject* and the data that is saved from the Android app is visible (Figure 19). **END** 

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